

Chapter 3

On Symphony No. 5, Op. 67, Movement 1

3.1 Introduction

This chapter transitions into a comparative analysis between d'Indy's and Caplin's approaches, using Beethoven's Symphony No. 5, Op. 67, Movement 1 as a case study. The movement, despite its revolutionary thematic development and structural innovations, adheres to a relatively textbook-friendly sonata form, making it an ideal foundation for exploring the theoretical differences between the two scholars. Both d'Indy and Caplin have engaged with this movement in their writings, treating some of its passages as ~~an~~ exemplary cases to illustrate Beethoven's compositional techniques. However, their analyses show significant discrepancies, particularly in defining formal boundaries and interpreting the roles of certain thematic materials, which underscores their distinct analytical priorities and methodologies.

D'Indy's theoretical perspective offers a unique lens for examining the movement, but it introduces some limitations in labeling specific sections, such as the transition. Conversely, Caplin's formal-functional theory appears to provide a clearer outline at background level. However, while his theory aims to categorize each section's function systematically, it encounters inconsistencies when applied to certain pas-

sages—in this movement, specifically, there is ambiguity regarding where the main theme actually begins, blurring the distinction between the thematic introduction and the main theme itself.

By comparing these conflicting interpretations, this chapter aims to expand on the contrasting assumptions and criteria that underlie each theorist's framework and how these differences impact our understanding of Beethoven's work. For d'Indy, his theory of genesis offers more internal consistency over Caplin's functional framework when dealing with formal ambiguity. However, as previously identified, his emphasis on homogeneity and motivic coherence can also introduce new issues, leading to interpretations that omits formal functions and blur distinct formal boundaries.

3.2 On the main theme

3.2.1 Vincent d'Indy's Analysis



Figure 3.1: mm. 1-5 treated as two rhythmic cells, followed by a generative period [d'Indy, 1909, p. 236].

D'Indy included an analysis of the first eight measures in both the "Beethovenian Sonata" chapter [d'Indy, 1909, p.236] and a concise form labeling in the "Symphony" chapter [d'Indy, 1933, pp. 129-30]. His inclusion of this example in the former chapter suggests that d'Indy's analytical approach presented there can equally apply to Beethoven's symphonic works, even though terms are sometimes used interchangeably. For instance, what is referred to as a "musical idea" in the sonata context is termed a "symphonic theme" in the symphonic chapter.

Shown in Fig. 3.1, d'Indy treats mm. 6-9 as a generative period and the opening

measures as rhythmic cells that, normally being part of that generative period, is stated separately and beforehand. He says,

The 5th Symphony, op. 67, also begins with a generating period of a rhythmic nature; however, the cell, instead of being part of the period as in op. 106, is stated separately and beforehand, on two different occasions. [d'Indy, 1909, p. 236, *translation mine*]

This suggests some variation of the hierarchical structure introduced earlier. Furthermore, in the "Symphony" chapter, d'Indy refers to these four measures as an introduction [d'Indy, 1933, p. 129]¹, noting that two rhythmic cells, which would typically belong to the generative period, are instead used to introduce it, being removed from their usual structural container.

Recalling the definition of a period, it is supposed to function as a container that encapsulates the generative theme. However, in this instance, d'Indy shifts the period's starting point five measures later, omitting the introductory measures from the container altogether. This decision is partially due to the thin texture of the opening. The introductory section lacks the structural and thematic weight characteristic of a complete period.

There is a notable texture shift at m. 6. Prior to this, the music is presented in tutti unison with a fermata that disrupts the musical flow. In contrast, m. 6 features greater texture depth, where the motive alternates between different voices, supported by a continuous line in the cello and bassoon. Dynamically, the opening feels abrupt and forceful whereas the generative period itself is quieter, more controlled, and refined.

D'Indy's analysis of the main theme section is limited to the opening 9 measures, suggesting an opportunity to complement his work with further exploration. Additionally, the rationale behind introducing cells before the generative periods requires further justification. In contrast, Caplin offers a complete analysis of the main theme

¹This term can be understood in a more general sense, rather than being as specifically defined as a thematic introduction in Caplin's framework.

section, providing a structural framework that can serve as a point of comparison and reference. His analysis raises particular observations about the labeling of the opening five measures, which aligns with a similar ambiguity in d'Indy's analysis. The comparative suggests that their theories reach a partial consensus, even though they are expressed through different discourses.

Espace inutile

3.2.2 Lemma Derived From Caplin's paradox

Espace?

In analyzing the main theme section of this movement, Caplin's own analysis reveals some inconsistencies when compared to his theoretical framework. To effectively compare Caplin's analysis with d'Indy's, it is important to first address these inconsistencies. By examining and resolving these issues, a solution is proposed as a lemma, which will later be applied to facilitate the comparison.

In his 1991 book chapter, Caplin treated the first four measures as a thematic introduction and the subsequent 16 measures as a sentence [Caplin, 1991, p. 28]. This interpretation sees measures 6-20 as a very conventional, textbook-styled sentence theme-type with an even distribution of presentation, continuation, and cadential functions, much like Caplin's analysis of the main theme of op. 2, No. 1 [Caplin, 2013, p. 34]. Starting at m. 5, which is on a tonal key, this approach makes sense as it fits the typical structure of a presentation in a sentence. However, this raises a significant issue because the prominent theme of the first four measures recurs throughout the piece. In Caplin's definition, a thematic introduction doesn't actually contain the main theme but rather an accompaniment pattern or something similar, making this interpretation less convincing.

The image displays a musical score for measures 1 through 21. The tempo is marked 'Allegro con brio'. The score is divided into several sections: (introduction) measures 1-5, presentation (basic idea) measures 7-11, continuation (fragmentation) measures 14-18, and cadential measures 19-21. The score includes dynamic markings such as *ff*, *p*, *cresc.*, and *f*. Below the staff, a harmonic analysis is provided, showing chords and their functions: C: (I) — (V) — I — V₅⁶ for the first system, and I — V₅⁶ — I — V₅⁶ — I — A⁶ (III.) — V for the second system. A box labeled 'HC' is present at the end of the second system.

Figure 3.2: mm. 1-5 treated as thematic introduction, followed by a sentence [Caplin, 1991, p. 28].

In this analysis, Caplin stated that, "Despite the manifestly dramatic importance of the opening measures, we learn, as the music progresses, that they actually serve to introduce the main theme proper, which begins at the upbeat to measure 7" [Caplin, 1991]. However, in *Analyzing Classical Form*, Caplin says,

"A thematic introduction is a short unit, rarely more than two measures, but sometimes just one or two chords. Its motivic content is minimal so as not to project any sense of being a basic idea. It often consists exclusively of accompanimental figurations that continue after the beginning of the theme" [Caplin, 2013, pp. 133-4],

which results in a contradiction. The motive in the opening measure is the foundation of the whole movement, even the whole symphony, which cannot conform to the purpose of "not to project any sense of being a basic idea," but rather, is

more than qualified to treat them as the basic idea. As a side note, there is a matter of nomenclature; the word "thematic" could cause confusion in this case of use, as according to Caplin, a thematic introduction is defined not to have such thematic function, but rather, "often consists exclusively of accompanimental figurations."



By rejecting the opening measures as thematic introduction, such contradiction disappears, yielding another interpretation treating the first five measures as the presentation, followed by a 13-measure continuation, and then wrapping up with a cadential arrival on m. 21, shown in Fig. 3.3. This method treats the initial measures as the main theme and fits them into a broader structural framework. However, this approach complicates matters, making the continuation section much longer than the presentation. This elongation of the middle section is a feature often seen in Caplin's analyses², but it raises questions about the practicality and complexity of his model. The continuation section becoming disproportionately long compared to the presentation section challenges the simplicity and clarity of the model, suggesting that this interpretation might overload the analytical framework with unnecessary complexity.



²This study contains such an example: The exposition of "Eroica," discussed later in this chapter, where, according to Caplinian analysis, the main theme and closing section are relatively short compared to the middle section, suggesting an unreasonable disproportion.

presentation

basic idea % b. i. continuation

Allegro con brio

c: (I) — (V) — I — V⁶₅ — I — V⁶₅ — I — A⁶ (III.) — V HC

Figure 3.3: mm. 1-5 treated as main theme, followed by long continuation.

Considering these points, I find the second interpretation less appealing despite its logical coherence. It proposes a more complex model that, while seemingly fitting the structure, makes the overall analysis less practical and overly complicated. This complexity detracts from the intuitive understanding of the piece, especially since the first four measures are a recurring and recognizable theme throughout the symphony.

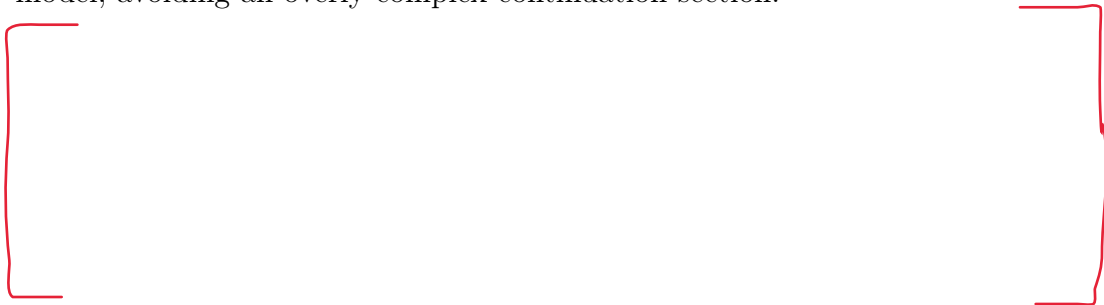
Therefore, while Caplin's framework offers various ways to analyze thematic structures, the specific case of Beethoven's Symphony No. 5, first movement, illustrates the challenges and limitations of fitting a prominent and recurring theme into a rigid analytical model. This example underscores the need for flexibility and adaptation in theoretical approaches to account for the unique characteristics of different musical pieces.

To resolve Caplin's paradox while remaining within the Caplinian framework, we need to develop or adopt a Neo-Caplinian theoretical model that allows for a basic

idea to appear before the presentation phrase. One such Neo-Caplinian concept is Janet Schmalfeldt's notion of becoming, which accommodates situations where a basic idea transitions into a presentation phrase. Schmalfeldt extensively explores this idea in her book [Schmalfeldt, 2011], providing a flexible framework that allows the incorporation of d'Indy's insight while extending the Caplinian model to address these formal ambiguities.



Fig. 3.4 illustrates the conciliatory analysis. Treating the first four measures as a presentation aligns with Caplin's language, where the presentation presents the basic idea. The subsequent measures, starting from m. 6, can be viewed as a continuation that evolves into a nested sentence, as demonstrated in Fig. 3.4. This approach solves the problem of identifying the basic idea of the main theme without resorting to the notion of a thematic introduction. It also simplifies the model, avoiding an overly complex continuation section.



By categorizing the first four measures as a presentation and the subsequent measures as a continuation functioning as a nested sentence, we achieve a structure that is both coherent and symmetrical. This nested sentence approach ensures that the continuation section does not become disproportionately long, thereby maintaining a more balanced and "square" structure. The second presentation, contained in the continuation phrase of the first presentation, has a relatively lower level of hierarchy.

Figure 3.4 shows a refined analysis of the main theme of op. 67, no. 1. The top staff, marked 'Allegro con brio', contains the 'presentation' phase. It begins with a 'basic idea' (measures 1-4) and is followed by a 'continuation => presentation (expanded)' (measures 5-11). The bottom staff continues the analysis, showing 'continuation (fragmentation)' (measures 14-18) and a 'cadential' section (measures 19-21). The 'cresc.' marking and 'f' dynamic are present in the cadential section. Below the staves, Roman numerals indicate the harmonic structure: (I), (V), I, V₅⁶, I, V₅⁶, I, A⁶ (III.), and V. A box labeled 'HC' is located at the bottom right.

Figure 3.4: Refined Analysis of the main theme of op. 67, no. 1.

3.2.3 Comparison

D'Indy and Caplin's theories show similarities in the roles of the generative period and the presentation phrase. For d'Indy, a generative period—also referred to as the initial period, which explicitly implies a "beginning" function—generates the second and third periods to complete a Dindyist phrase. Similarly, in Caplin's model, a presentation phrase serves the "beginning" function within a strophic theme, presenting thematic content that subsequently develops through continuation and cadential phrases to complete the sentence.

Shown in Fig. 3.5, mm. 10–13 are labeled as a repeated generative period, given that they are an exact restatement of the content in mm. 6–9.³ As a result, that

³This analysis is based on the earlier discussion of the Hammerklavier, where even when the second statement of the motto is slightly altered from the first, it is still considered a repeated generative period. In the current example, however, the repetition is exact, making it more accurate

Caplinian four-measure basic idea occupies the same passage as a generative period in d'Indy's terminology, and that Caplinian eight-measure presentation phrase occupies the same passage as a a group of two generative periods.



The image shows a musical score for piano in 2/4 time, spanning 21 measures. The score is divided into two systems. The first system contains measures 1 through 10, and the second system contains measures 14 through 21. Various annotations are present throughout the score, including measure numbers in boxes, dynamic markings, and structural labels.

Measure 1: Labeled with a boxed '1'. Above the staff, it says 'presentation basic idea d'Indy: rhythmic cell'. The music starts with a forte (*ff*) dynamic and a rhythmic cell of eighth notes.

Measure 5: Labeled with a boxed '5'. Above the staff, it says 'continuation => presentation (expanded)'. The music continues with a piano (*p*) dynamic.

Measure 10: Labeled with a boxed '10'. Above the staff, it says '% basic idea second period'. The music continues with a piano (*p*) dynamic.

Measure 14: Labeled with a boxed '14'. Above the staff, it says 'continuation third period'. The music continues with a piano (*p*) dynamic.

Measure 21: Labeled with a boxed '21'. Above the staff, it says 'cadential'. The music ends with a half cadence.

Other annotations include 'c.i.' (crescendo), 'V' (Vivace), 'V^g' (Vivace), 'cresc.' (crescendo), 'A⁶' (Allegretto), and 'V|HC' (Vivace).

Figure 3.5: Analysis of Caplin vs Analysis of d'Indy.⁴

While the Neo-Caplinian analysis suggests a nested structure as discussed earlier, d'Indy's analysis also exhibits a nested structure where the initial four measures exhibit structural duality. On one hand, according to d'Indy's hierarchical model, a cell is part of a generative period. In this instance, however, the two cells at the beginning, to some extent, has a higher level of hierarchy than a period-contained cell because they stand on their own outside of the container. We can thus recognize that complexity arises when analyzing a compact passage with an exhaustively restated short-short-long motive, as it necessitates adapting established theoretical frameworks to account for the passage's structural ambiguity and layered hierarchies.

Such challenges may explain d'Indy's omission of discussion for the remainder of the section where the motive is repeatedly used. This repetition poses no issue for Caplin, as his analysis relies more on harmonic and formal function. For him, the half cadence in m. 21 closes the main theme, followed by a transition that develops

to label it as a faithful repetition of the generative period.

material from the main theme, structured around his preference for grouping by means of closure. In d'Indy's framework, however, the rest of this passage remains ambiguous, as he provides no analysis for these later fragments. As discussed earlier, d'Indy emphasizes grouping through parallelism. However, since the motive recurs throughout, it becomes challenging to establish distinct groupings. It is, therefore, not particularly useful to try to apply d'Indy's approach to analyze these remaining passages. This perspective is further supported by d'Indy's labeling of the transition section, which provides evidence for this interpretation.

3.3 On the transition

D'Indy labeled the transition as four measures with a straightforward assertion, which requires interpretation. Notably, there is a rhythmic stop on m. 60, which could suggest why he marked this point as the beginning of a separate formal section. However, there was also a rhythmic stop earlier in m. 21 as shown in Example 3.5, which he did not treat as the end of the main theme. One possible explanation is that d'Indy considers a continuous chunk of music featuring a succession of homogeneous materials as a single section. In this movement, the motives are varied but consistently repeated from mm. 1-60. D'Indy attempts to incorporate homogeneous material into what he considers a single theme until materials change, which is challenging since the same motive plays until m. 62. D'Indy tries to incorporate this stretch of homogeneous material into a single thematic section until there is a noticeable change in content, which is challenging since the same motive continues until m. 62.

D'Indy extends his analysis up to m. 60, interpreting the continuous use of similar materials as one cohesive unit, only recognizing the need to separate sections as the subordinate theme approaches. Instead of transitioning directly from the first thematic section to the second, d'Indy allocates four measures for the transition immediately after the rhythmic break at m. 60. D'Indy's decision reflects his desire for the exposition to follow a complete structure, encompassing the transition



component.



Figure 3.6: Transition of op. 67, no. 1 (mm. 61-63) [d'Indy, 1933, p.130].

It appears that d'Indy did not operate within a framework where a functional perspective was prevalent. According to Caplin, the first cadence syntactically closes the main theme at m. 21, concluding that sentential formal section, and then transitions into a new section that utilizes homogeneous materials while modulating to the relative major.

3.3.1 Discussion

D'Indy's preference for parallelism in grouping, organizing similar materials into unified categories, creates issues when applied to Beethoven's Fifth Symphony. By reducing the transition to a mere four measures, this perspective disrupts the conventional balance and structure of the exposition, diminishing the dynamic contrast typically essential in sonata form. The more this analysis is pushed toward such an extreme, the more its limitations become apparent, as it overlooks the functional distinctions between sections in favor of surface-level uniformity.

For Caplin, however, this is not a problem. Caplin's theory does not hinge on the continuity or genesis of thematic content. Instead, his focus is on harmony, bassline movement, and the nature of cadences. These elements, rather than the thematic material, take precedence in defining form. This explains why Caplin can use Beethoven 5 as an exemplary piece to illustrate Beethovenian composition—his framework is well-suited to handle its harmonic and cadential structures, even when thematic repetition is present.



3.4 Conclusion

Providing a complete analysis of Beethoven's 5th Symphony, Op. 67, would have made d'Indy's theory of the genesis of musical ideas appear highly effective. His approach, centered on the generation and development of a core idea, aligns perfectly with this movement, where the iconic short-short-short-long motive permeates almost every section, providing a clear example of how a single cell can contribute to the generation an entire movement.

However, despite the suitability of this piece, d'Indy only briefly mentions the movement's beginning as an example of generative period. In his corpus on the nine Beethovenian Symphonies, he did not provide a thorough analysis analysis either. This is a missed opportunity, but it may have been a deliberate choice.

The reason for this omission could be that, while Beethoven's 5th Symphony provides a near-perfect demonstration of his theory, d'Indy recognized that most other Beethoven sonata movements do not share such an evenly distributed thematic consistency. Many works have more varied thematic content and a less uniform application of a single generative idea. As a result, using this piece to exemplify his theory would have highlighted its strengths in this specific context but could make his framework seem less adaptable to other sonata movements that lack such motivic cohesion.

Therefore, to keep his theory versatile and applicable across a broader range of examples, d'Indy may have intentionally refrained from overemphasizing this movement or other movements where his concept of genesis could overshadow the theory's adaptability. In doing so, d'Indy deliberately downplayed the unique strengths of his approach in this particular movement to maintain its broader applicability, sacrificing some sharpness and specificity in favor of flexibility.

Instead, d'Indy chose to use the Hammerklavier Sonata as his exemplar piece, as it provides a more fitting context for demonstrating his theory's handling of both unified and contrasting materials. Furthermore, it brings to light similar discrepancies between his analysis and Caplin's in terms of form labeling, which will be



addressed in the following chapter.